

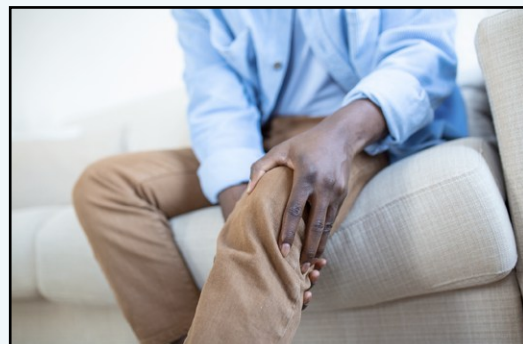


GCN Best Practices, Part II

Best Practices Based on Patient Complaint

Joint Pain

- Before ordering a rheumatologic workup, suggest patient be examined.
- Do not order labs such as ESR, CRP—these can be nonspecific in nature.
- Order labs with intention and think about what you would do if these labs were abnormal.
- Advising in-person exam first helps guide any further workup.



Fatigue

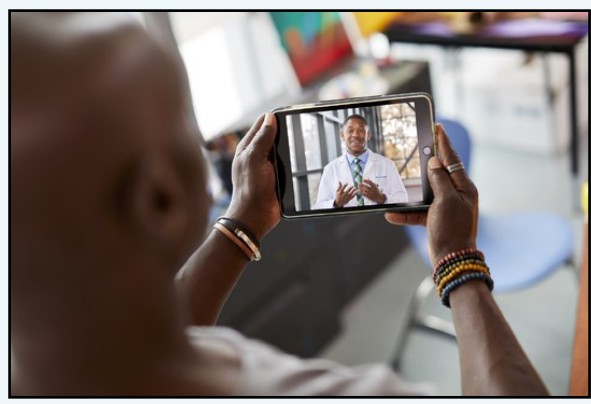
You can order the following labs:

- CBC
- TSH
- Folic acid
- Iron
- B12
- You can also consider a sleep study if there is loud snoring and daytime drowsiness.
- For pediatric patients, consider CBC and TSH labs.

UTI in Females, ≥ 18 Years

You do not need to order a UA for everyone. However, consider ordering a UA if:

- Male
- HIV Positive
- SmartRX UTI doesn't pertain to men
- Diabetic
- Immunosuppressed
- Recent treatment failure
- Pregnancy
- Third UTI in 12 months



UTI in Males, ≥ 18 Years

- If younger age: Consider nongonococcal urethritis.
- If older than 40 or 50, consider prostatitis/epididymitis.
- Order urine studies appropriate to history and your conversation with patient (can include UA, culture, gonorrhea/chlamydia).
- A UTI from a female partner can not be transferred to a male unless it's an STD.

Pediatric UTI ≤ 18 Years

- Order stat UA and UCx to confirm.
- Okay to treat presumptively for UTI pending UCx if it's a toilet-trained girl age 4+ with classic UTI symptoms, no signs of vulvovaginitis, no red flags. Preferably, wait for UA/UCx prior to treatment (if able) due to high prevalence of urethritis.

Vaginitis

- Treat presumptively. Do not test everyone.
 - History of BV with similar symptoms and foul odor
 - White, clumpy discharge with itching and no odor
- Consider GC/CT testing, if appropriate.
- Test if diagnosis is unclear.
- **Do not** include this for every patient with UTI symptoms.



Diarrhea

- Suggest supportive care: Pepto Bismol; Imodium. Anti-diarrheal agents are *not* routinely recommended in children.
- Order stool studies if symptoms are present for over a week.
- If there is concern for C. diff, recent antibiotics, such as clindamycin, mucoid stool — can even get treatment started if suspicion is high while C. diff studies are pending.
- You don't have to order stool studies for traveler's diarrhea; it's okay to treat presumptively or with conservative measures.

Abdominal Pain

- Avoid ordering any stat labs.
- If pain is chronic, then recommend in-person evaluation with PCP, who will order a workup once patient is examined.

Requests for Medications



Refills for Chronic Conditions

- Do not order any scheduled medications (benzodiazepines, Adderall, narcotic pain medications)
- If they need a refill of a chronic medication (for diabetes, hypertension, cholesterol, etc.), then order it and put PCP as refill provider.
- This includes steroid creams, NSAIDs, and antivirals for cold sores/genital herpes.

Provera for Vaginal Bleeding

- **Do not** refill Provera for a woman with persistent vaginal bleeding.
- It's recommended that the patient follows up with gynecology.

Medications for Acute Illness

When ordering antibiotics, antivirals for shingles, emergency contraception, Tessalon, muscle relaxants, and prednisone:

- **Limit** the date of expiration.
- Type "S+10" as the medication end date.
- Save this to your preference list.

General GCN Advice

Avoid Making Promises

- Avoid sending patients in to be seen and promising studies will be done.
- **Example:** Patient requests MRI—advise they follow up in person for further evaluation. It should be made clear that any necessary orders will be determined by the examining clinician.
- **Example:** Patient requests IV fluids because they feel dehydrated. Patient can be assessed in person, and the examining clinician will determine if IV fluids are necessary.



Be Mindful When CCing a Patient's PCP

- Avoid this if patient needs a follow-up.
- PCPs **cannot** schedule visits.
- Ask the patient to book a follow-up.
- Some messages may be more appropriate for a patient's specialist.

For Additional GCN Best Practices

For additional GCN best practices tips, [please check out Part I of this series.](#)